REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL / RFP

Android Launcher for Older Adults

Hamrah Sadeh | Persian Senior-Friendly Launcher

A product and delivery specification covering competitor research, target users, functional requirements, Android constraints, proposed architecture, roadmap, acceptance criteria, and vendor evaluation.

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This document is intended for vendor solicitation and product planning. Estimates and quantitative targets are preliminary and must be validated during discovery and contracting.

1. Executive Summary

Working name: Hamrah Sadeh | Category: Android Launcher / Accessibility / Family Assistance | Target market: Iran and Persian-speaking users

The objective is to develop a fully Persian-language Android launcher that transforms a complex smartphone home screen into a simple, readable, and understandable interface for older adults.

Once selected as the default launcher by the user, the app replaces the device's home screen. It enables everyday tasks without requiring users to understand the complexity of Android's standard interface.

Core activities include calling family members, finding contacts, opening WhatsApp, viewing photos, accessing messages, using the camera, and requesting help.

> **Core product proposition:** Rather than offering only oversized icons, the solution must address three needs simultaneously: **simplicity, user independence, and family assistance.**

1. **Simplicity:** Older adults should be able to complete essential tasks independently.
2. **Independence:** Users should not need to call a family member for every minor problem.
3. **Family assistance:** With the older adult's consent, a trusted family member should be able to configure settings and shortcuts.

Whenever practical, the product must operate without internet access, account registration, or server infrastructure.

2. Market Research and Competitor Analysis

Senior-focused Android launchers are an established category. A home screen consisting solely of large buttons is not a sufficient competitive advantage.

BIG Launcher

An established product offering simplified calling and messaging, large notifications, customization, and an SOS function. At the time of the original research, its Persian-language Google Play listing indicated more than one million downloads.

Opportunity: Deeper localization for Iranian users and more effective family assistance.

BaldPhone

A free, open-source project with a launcher, contacts, medication reminders, video guides, and accessibility-oriented features.

Implication: Medication reminders or SOS functionality alone are not unique differentiators.

Elder Launcher
A lightweight, open-source launcher with larger icons, favorite contacts, and customizable shortcuts.

Implication: Simplicity can be more valuable than a long feature list.

Samsung Easy Mode
An option on compatible Samsung phones that enlarges text and icons and simplifies elements of the system interface.

Competitive threat: This built-in, free feature may be sufficient for some target users.

2.1. Findings from usability research

A study involving 50 older users found that a dedicated senior launcher did not necessarily deliver a substantial advantage in task completion over a standard launcher, although it could improve task speed. Lower interface complexity correlated with better performance.

A systematic review of app design research for older adults also emphasizes large touch targets, adequate spacing, straightforward navigation, readable typography, and practical guidance.

Product implication: The design must be tested with real older adults rather than based only on a younger designer's assumptions about simplicity.

2.2. Opportunity in the Iranian market

The following are hypotheses to investigate among Persian-speaking users:

- Demand for an interface designed from the outset for Persian, right-to-left layout, and the Solar Hijri calendar.
- Photo-based contact shortcuts for quickly calling children, relatives, and caregivers.
- Difficulty navigating device settings, system notifications, and numerous installed applications.
- A need for spoken Persian instructions and everyday explanations of technical terms.
- A need for family members to assist with onboarding without unnecessary access to private information.

> These are **product hypotheses, not proven market demand.** Interviews and hands-on tests are necessary before commercial investment.

2.3. Identified Iranian competitors

Product	Core features	Observed status
Khaneh Salemnd (Senior Home)	Photo-based calling for nine selected contacts, video playback, simple settings.	Listed at 200,000 tomans with fewer than ten installs at the time of review.

Product	Core features	Observed status
Riboz	Quick calls to four contacts in a restricted interface.	One user review visible on the Bazaar listing at the time of review.

BIG Launcher also provides a Persian website, photo contacts, and PIN protection for settings. Therefore, **Persian localization, photo calling, and a settings PIN are not sufficient differentiators on their own.**

> **Recommended positioning:** An offline-first, exceptionally simple Persian launcher, validated with Iranian older adults, with family assistance and step-by-step onboarding as key parts of the experience.

3. User Personas and Primary Use Cases

User group	Primary need	Proposed approach
Independent older adult, 60-70	Easier smartphone use without losing essential functionality	Simple mode with access to the full app list
Less experienced older adult, 70-85	Calling, photos, messages, and a few selected apps	Stable home screen with photo contacts
User with visual or motor limitations	Easier tapping, reading, and error avoidance	Large controls, high contrast, optional spoken feedback
Family member or caregiver	Initial setup and troubleshooting	Family settings mode and support instructions

These are provisional personas. Age alone must not determine the interface mode: actual ability and user preference should drive configuration.

4. User Experience and Interface Principles

4.1. Proposed home screen

Unlike a conventional launcher, the home screen should not expose dozens of apps and widgets. The initial concept is intentionally restrained:



Illustrative wireframe only. The production interface will use Persian labels and RTL layout and must be refined through usability testing.

4.2. Mandatory design principles

Property	Initial design target
Interface direction	Full Persian and genuine right-to-left support
Main text size	20-24sp by default; adjustable
Button labels	20-24sp
Button dimensions	Preferably at least 80dp high for primary actions
Control spacing	At least 8-12dp
Contrast	At least 4.5:1 for regular text
Navigation	No mandatory complex gestures
Feedback	Clear visual state, optional haptics or voice
Legibility	Do not rely on icon-only controls for critical tasks
Interaction depth	Core actions accessible within one or two taps
Wording	Everyday language instead of technical jargon

These are initial targets, not validated dimensions. User testing may change them. For example, "Other apps" is preferable to "Application Manager," and "App permissions" is preferable to a less familiar technical term.

5. Functional Requirements

Priorities are grouped as **P0** (mandatory MVP), **P1** (next release), and **P2** (advanced or future scope).

5.1. Mandatory MVP capabilities

ID	Feature	Requirement	Priority
FR01	Default launcher	Register and request selection as Android Home app with the user's consent.	P0
FR02	Simplified home screen	Display six to eight primary functions and allow their arrangement to be customized.	P0
FR03	Photo contacts	Allow four to nine favorite contacts, including names and photos.	P0
FR04	Quick calling	Tap a contact, show their name, and confirm the call.	P0
FR05	Favorite apps	Add or remove shortcuts to installed applications.	P0
FR06	Large text and controls	Provide three adjustable size levels with preview.	P0
FR07	Family settings	Offer a separate advanced settings section protected by an optional PIN.	P0
FR08	Persian localization	Provide Persian language, Solar Hijri dates, and full RTL support.	P0
FR09	Request help	Clearly identify a trusted emergency contact and launch dialing.	P0
FR10	Onboarding	Guide users through selecting the default launcher and configuring contacts.	P0
FR11	Recovery	Support settings reset and a clear path to exit or replace the launcher.	P0
FR12	Offline use	Core functionality must work without internet or an account.	P0
FR13	App directory	Show permitted apps in a readable list with understandable names.	P0
FR14	Persian help	Include short visual tutorials for calling and basic app interactions.	P0

5.2. Release 1.1 capabilities

ID	Feature	Requirement	Priority
FR15	Medication reminders	Schedule reminders and record adherence; no medical advice.	P1
FR16	Persian voice assistance	Read interface labels and support a limited set of voice commands.	P1
FR17	Simplified notifications	Show important notifications only after explicit user permission.	P1
FR18	Internet calling shortcuts	Open supported calling interfaces in third-party apps.	P1
FR19	Ultra-simple mode	Display four trusted contacts and a help button only.	P1
FR20	Backup and restore	Export settings for migration to another device.	P1

5.3. Future capabilities

- **FR21:** Family dashboard for consent-based configuration changes.
- **FR22:** Guided troubleshooting for issues such as disabled notifications or an unselected default launcher.
- **FR23:** Interactive Persian audio and video tutorials.
- **FR24:** AI guidance within the launcher's own interface, without automated control of third-party apps.
- **FR25:** Personalization profiles for visual, motor, or cognitive accessibility needs.

Remote family support must be optional and narrowly scoped. Unrestricted phone control, private message reading, or covert access is not part of the requirements.

6. User Journeys and System Scenarios

Scenario A: First-time setup

1. A family member installs the launcher on the older adult's phone.
2. Persian and either Simple or Ultra-simple mode are selected.
3. The app explains how to choose it as the device's default launcher.
4. Important contacts are selected from the address book or added manually.
5. Essential apps, such as WhatsApp and Camera, are pinned.
6. Text and button sizes are adjusted together with the older adult.
7. The settings PIN is enabled if desired.
8. The older adult reviews the final screen and tries several primary tasks.

Target family-assisted setup time: under five minutes, excluding download, installation, and sign-in to third-party apps.

Scenario B: Calling a child or family member

The user opens the home screen, selects "My Family," taps the family member's photo, and confirms the call. If direct calling permission is unavailable, the system dialer opens with the number prefilled.

Scenario C: User becomes confused

The user opens "Help" to access short illustrated instructions for common actions, each with a clear "Back to Home" control. The guide must work offline.

Scenario D: Requesting assistance

The user taps "Request Help." The app displays the trusted contact's name prominently and provides an action to initiate a call.

A secondary contact can be considered in a later release. This feature must not be presented as a guaranteed emergency response or medical detection service.

7. Technical Requirements and Android Constraints

Some capabilities that appear straightforward are not fully available to an ordinary Android launcher.

7.1. Operating system constraints

Capability	Technical feasibility
Replace the device home screen	Supported after the user selects the app as their Home launcher.
List installed applications	Supported subject to Android package visibility restrictions.
Open third-party apps	Supported using official Intents and Android APIs.
Open telephone dialer	Supported through ACTION_DIAL.
Place a direct telephone call	Requires appropriate permissions and device-level testing.
Read or display SMS messages	Subject to restrictive SMS access and default-handler rules.
Modify the WhatsApp interface	Not generally possible from a third-party launcher.
Completely block Android settings	Cannot be guaranteed by an ordinary launcher.
Replace the system lock screen	Not fully controlled by a normal launcher.
Remotely control other apps	Subject to significant security and platform-policy restrictions.

Android's **RoleManager** provides a user-approved mechanism for requesting **ROLE_HOME**. Standard system Intents should be preferred for dialing and messaging.

> **Mandatory constraint:** No essential feature may require root access.

7.2. Google Play compliance

Under Google's published requirements applicable from August 31, 2026, new mobile apps and app updates generally need to target Android 16 (API level 36) or higher unless a documented exception applies. The exact requirements must be verified again before release.

- Being a launcher does not automatically grant SMS or call-log access; these permissions are restricted by Google Play.
- Accessibility Services may only be used where genuinely necessary and consistent with platform and store policies.
- Discovering installed apps is subject to Android package visibility requirements.
- Exact alarms for time-sensitive reminders require attention to current permission and scheduling restrictions.

8. Proposed Architecture

8.1. Technology selection

The recommended stack is **Kotlin + Jetpack Compose**. Flutter can implement a launcher, but this product is heavily dependent on native Android APIs. Kotlin reduces platform-channel bridging and makes system integration more straightforward.

Technology	Purpose
Kotlin	Primary application language
Jetpack Compose	User interface
Material 3 (customized)	Reusable UI components
Android SDK	Home role, contacts, calling, installed apps
Room	Local structured storage
DataStore	Launcher settings and preferences
AlarmManager	Time-sensitive scheduled reminders when justified
WorkManager	Non-time-critical background jobs
Android Keystore	Protection of sensitive secrets and keys
Firebase (optional)	Future cloud-assisted features

8.2. Modular structure

Presentation Layer
Compose UI / RTL / Accessibility
↓
Feature Modules
Launcher / Contacts / Shortcuts / Emergency / Settings / Onboarding
↓
Data and Platform Layer
Room / DataStore / Android APIs
↓
Android System
Home Role / Package Manager / Dialer / Contacts

The MVP should not require a backend, user authentication, family accounts, or cloud infrastructure. If remote family management is approved later, that architecture and its estimated effort must be specified separately.

9. Nonfunctional Requirements (NFR)

ID	Category	Initial acceptance target
NFR01	Compatibility	Android 9 and later as an initial target, validated on real devices.
NFR02	Reliability	At least 99.5% crash-free sessions during the pilot.
NFR03	Performance	Home screen visible within two seconds of process readiness on a reference device.
NFR04	Offline support	Calling, shortcuts, contacts, and settings usable without internet.
NFR05	Privacy	No contact information or personal data sent to servers.
NFR06	Accessibility	Support system font scaling and TalkBack for core tasks.
NFR07	Recovery	Persist launcher configuration after device restart.
NFR08	Battery	No unnecessary persistent background service.
NFR09	Security	Protect advanced settings and provide a safe exit path.
NFR10	Installation	No root requirement or unjustified sensitive permissions.

Performance and stability targets must also be tested on budget and mid-range devices, not only emulators and premium phones.

10. Security, Privacy, and User Autonomy

Mandatory product principles:

1. Keep data on the device by default.
2. Do not display intrusive or full-screen advertisements.
3. Do not secretly open apps or content without the user's knowledge.
4. Use a family PIN to prevent accidental changes, not to remove the device owner's autonomy.
5. Provide a clearly documented path back to the original Android launcher.
6. Do not grant family members access to contacts, notifications, location, or personal information without explicit consent.
7. Request sensitive permissions when the relevant feature is used, rather than requesting everything at first launch.

> **Security clarification:** A PIN implemented inside a launcher is an application-level safeguard, not a system-wide security lock.

11. Project Delivery Plan

11.1. Proposed phases

Phase 01: Research and Validation
Weeks 1-2
Interview 10-15 older adults, audit representative devices, and test paper or Figma prototypes.

Phase 02: Product Design
Week 3
Finalize user flows, Persian UI design, Simple and Ultra-simple modes, and an interactive prototype.

Phase 03: Core Launcher Implementation
Weeks 4-6
Implement Home role, home screen, favorite contacts, app shortcuts, settings, and local persistence.

Phase 04: Complete the MVP
Weeks 7-8
Add onboarding, the help call feature, adjustable sizing, permission flows, and launcher recovery.

Phase 05: Real-world User Testing
Weeks 9-10
Run senior usability sessions, fix usability issues, and test across device manufacturers.

Phase 06: Pilot Release
Weeks 11-12
Resolve final defects, complete documentation and privacy policy, and distribute a pilot build.

Estimated MVP delivery: 10-12 weeks with one experienced Android developer and part-time design and testing support. This estimate excludes a remote administration dashboard, a general AI assistant, and a custom SMS application.

11.2. Estimated engineering effort

Activity	Estimated person-hours
Product discovery and requirements	30-50
UX/UI design and prototyping	40-70
MVP implementation	200-300
Testing, compatibility, and fixes	80-120
Release and documentation	20-30
Total	**370-570**

These are planning estimates, not contractor quotes or independently surveyed market rates.

12. Acceptance Criteria

Vendors must demonstrate successful completion of clearly defined user scenarios.

Test	Acceptable outcome
Install and activate	The app becomes the default Home launcher after explicit user approval and is shown when Home is invoked.
Call a contact	A user can select a photo contact and initiate a call with minimal effort.
Persistence	Launcher and configuration persist after reboot.
Offline operation	Primary features remain available without an internet connection.
Customization	Changes to contacts and app shortcuts persist after restarting the app.
Family settings	Advanced settings can be guarded by an optional PIN.
Accessibility	The largest text setting does not hide essential actions.
Request help	The correct number is shown and the call flow is clear.

Test	Acceptable outcome
Exit	The user can restore the previous default launcher.
Compatibility	Tested on at least six physical devices from three manufacturers.

12.1. Usability testing with older adults

At least 15 older adults should complete a structured acceptance test without step-by-step prompting.

Metric	Proposed pilot target
Successful calling of a favorite contact	90%
Successful discovery of a requested app	85%
Median time to initiate a call	30 seconds
Successful return to the home screen	90%

These values are proposed acceptance targets, not observed study results. Record mis-taps, requests for assistance, confusion, and difficulty locating Back or Home controls.

13. Required Deliverables

1. Complete Android source code with Git history.
2. Signed installation APK and release-ready Android App Bundle (AAB).
3. Figma design files and reusable components.
4. Architecture and setup documentation.
5. Automated tests and manual test reports.
6. Persian installation and user guides for older adults and family members.
7. Usability study report and documentation of fixes made.
8. Permission rationale and privacy policy documentation.
9. Store-ready assets for Cafe Bazaar, Myket, and Google Play as permitted by each storefront.
10. Release signing key handover and secure key-management documentation according to the ownership agreement.

The final handover should include a post-acceptance defect-fix period. A 30-day period is proposed.

14. Vendor Proposal Requirements

Responding companies and individual developers should submit proposals with the following content:

Section	Required information
Company or developer profile	Relevant Android project experience.
Technical track record	Native Android, launcher, or accessibility-related examples.
Solution approach	Architecture and rationale for technology choices.
Delivery team	Roles, staffing, and expected allocation.
Project plan	Phase durations and milestones.
Commercial offer	Fixed-fee or time-and-materials pricing, broken down by phase.
Risks and assumptions	Android constraints, permissions, and device compatibility.
Maintenance	Support, defect remediation, and update terms.
Ownership	Rights to source code, designs, and publishing assets.

14.1. Proposal evaluation

Criterion	Weight
Native Android experience and system API competence	30%
UX quality and accessibility	25%
Architecture, testability, and security	20%
Proposed price	15%
Schedule and support	10%

15. Key Project Risks

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
Differences across Samsung, Xiaomi, and other vendors	High	Begin physical-device testing during early development.
Changes in Android platform behavior	High	Use official APIs and maintain a version test matrix.
Users cannot return to launcher from other apps	High	Teach navigation and test both gesture and button navigation.
Scope grows beyond a usable simple interface	High	Enforce clear MVP boundaries.

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
UI language is confusing to older adults	Medium	Test actual wording and revise from research findings.
Store rejection or sensitive permission problems	High	Minimize permissions and review policy before implementation.
Poor performance on older phones	Medium	Avoid unnecessary background processing and services.
Internet dependency for essential features	High	Design offline-first from the start.

16. Proposed Business Model

Advertising inside a senior-oriented home screen is a poor fit. It can cause accidental taps, confusion, and reduced trust.

The initial recommendation is a **freemium model with an optional one-time upgrade.**

Tier	Included capabilities	Monetization
Free	Launcher, photo contacts, text sizing, app shortcuts, and help calling.	Free forever
Full	Advanced profiles, backup, voice guidance, and additional customization.	One-time purchase
Family	Opt-in synchronization and remote configuration assistance.	Potential future subscription

Basic calling and help features should not be paywalled. Pricing should be based on willingness-to-pay research with target families. Low download counts among some competitors do not, by themselves, prove either low or high market demand.

17. Out of Scope

The initial MVP must not include the following, in order to keep complexity and costs under control:

- A complete custom messaging application or dialer.
- A replacement Android lock screen.
- Continuous geolocation tracking.
- Covert family control of the device.
- Automatic banking or messaging actions.
- A general-purpose intelligent voice assistant.
- Medical interpretation, health surveillance, or automatic emergency detection.

- An iOS equivalent: iOS does not allow third-party apps to replace the default launcher in the same way as Android.

18. Conclusions and Recommendation

The most valuable starting point is a **minimal Persian Android launcher centered on easy calls, photo-based contacts, favorite apps, and family-assisted setup.**

However, immediately implementing the entire proposed scope is not recommended.

First, create a prototype with three capabilities: the home screen, photo-based calling, and simplified app management. Test it with 10-15 older adults. If results show that users complete tasks more easily and independently, a full MVP investment becomes better justified.

Three success factors: demonstrated usability, compatibility with common phones in Iran, and trust from older adults and their families. Simply adding more features will not achieve these outcomes.

> **Final RFP recommendation:** Build a native Android, offline-first, Persian-language product with a tightly scoped MVP, mandatory usability research, and room for later family-assistance features. The initial MVP delivery estimate is approximately 10-12 weeks.

Key sources and implementation references

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